THE NQ PRECISION PLAYBOOK

Session Levels · Volume Profile · High-Probability Setups

80 TICK ALPHA

NQ Execution Room

"Structure. Patience. Discipline."

// CONTENTS

What's Inside

01 The Strategy Overview
Philosophy + Core Rules

02 Key Levels Breakdown
Session Opens, Prev Highs/Lows

03 Volume Profile Explained
POC, VAH, VAL + How to Use Them

04 Trade Setup Examples
Long + Short Confluences

05 Risk Management & Psychology
Protecting Your Edge

This guide breaks down the complete 80 Tick Alpha NQ Futures methodology — the exact framework used to identify high-probability trade setups on Nasdaq-100 E-mini futures. No indicators sold here yet. Just the core logic.

// CHAPTER 01

The Strategy Overview

Most retail traders lose because they chase price. This strategy doesn't chase. It waits — patiently — at levels where institutions have historically transacted, where volume confirms intent, and where multiple time frames agree.

> *"The market always tells you where it wants to go. Your job is to listen — not lead."*

Core Philosophy

The 80 Tick Alpha strategy is built on a single thesis: price has memory. Every time a session opens, closes, or creates a high/low — that price level becomes a future magnet. Institutions reference these levels. Algorithms are programmed around them. Understanding this means you're trading with the flow of capital, not against it.

SESSION LEVELS ARE KING	Previous highs, lows, opens, and closes form the backbone of every trade decision. No Fibonacci. No arbitrary support.
CONFLUENCE = CONVICTION	When two or more session levels stack within ~5 points, probability increases dramatically. These [x2] [x3] zones are your highest-conviction setups.
VOLUME CONFIRMS THE STORY	The Point of Control (POC), Value Area High (VAH), and Value Area Low (VAL) show where the most trading activity occurred. Price returns to value.
EXECUTION ON 80-TICK RANGE BARS	Range bars remove time distortion. Every bar represents equal price movement, giving cleaner entries and exits than time-based charts.
1-3 TRADES PER SESSION MAX	Quality over quantity. Wait for the setup to come to you. If it doesn't, there's no trade.

The 3-Panel Setup

Effective NQ trading requires multi-frame context. The 80 Tick Alpha setup uses three chart panels simultaneously to separate context, sentiment, and execution.

PANEL	CHART	PURPOSE
LEFT	30-Minute + Session Volume Profile	Context — where are the key levels?
TOP RIGHT	Mag 7 Screener + Reversal Table (1-min)	Sentiment — which way is capital flowing?
BOTTOM RIGHT	80-Tick Range Bars + Volume Profile	Execution — where do I pull the trigger?

FIG 1.1 — The 80 Tick Alpha NQ Execution Room: context, levels, sentiment + execution in one view

// CHAPTER 02

Key Levels Breakdown

Session-based levels are the scaffolding of every trade. These aren't drawn by hand — they're objective, automatically plotted, and universally referenced by institutions and algorithmic systems alike.

The Level Hierarchy

LEVEL	DESCRIPTION	SIGNIFICANCE
Yearly Open	Price at the start of the calendar year	Macro anchor
Quarterly Open	Start of current quarter (Q1–Q4)	Institutional reference
Monthly Open	First price of the month	Medium-term bias
Weekly Open	Monday's opening price	Weekly trend anchor
Prev Day High/Low	Yesterday's session H and L	Daily S/R
Prev 4H High/Low	Previous 4-hour bar H and L	Intraday context
Prev 1H High/Low	Previous 1-hour bar H and L	Execution precision

Why These Levels Work

These aren't arbitrary lines. Every session open represents a decision point — a moment when institutional desks reassess exposure. Previous session highs and lows represent the outer boundary of accepted price. When price revisits these levels, algorithms and order flow predictably respond.

AT SUPPORT LEVELS — LOOK FOR:

- Price approaching from above with decreasing momentum
- Volume profile POC or VAL confirming the zone
- Confluence with a session open or prev low [x2]
- 80-tick bars showing bullish reversal candle pattern

 AT RESISTANCE LEVELS — LOOK FOR:

Price approaching from below with diminishing momentum

Volume profile VAH or POC acting as ceiling

Confluence with prev high or session open [x2] or [x3]

80-tick bars showing rejection / bearish reversal signal

Confluence Zones [x2] [x3]

A confluence zone exists when two or more session levels stack within approximately 5 points of each other. These zones represent the highest-probability trade locations in the entire strategy. The more levels that converge, the stronger the expected reaction.

CONFLUENCE	EXAMPLE	EXPECTED REACTION
[x2]	Prev 1H Low + Weekly Open = 21,450	Moderate — trade with confirmation
[x3]	Prev Day Low + 4H Low + POC = 21,448	Strong — higher conviction entry
[x4+]	Monthly Open + Daily Low + VAL + 1H Low	Maximum — treat as major S/R

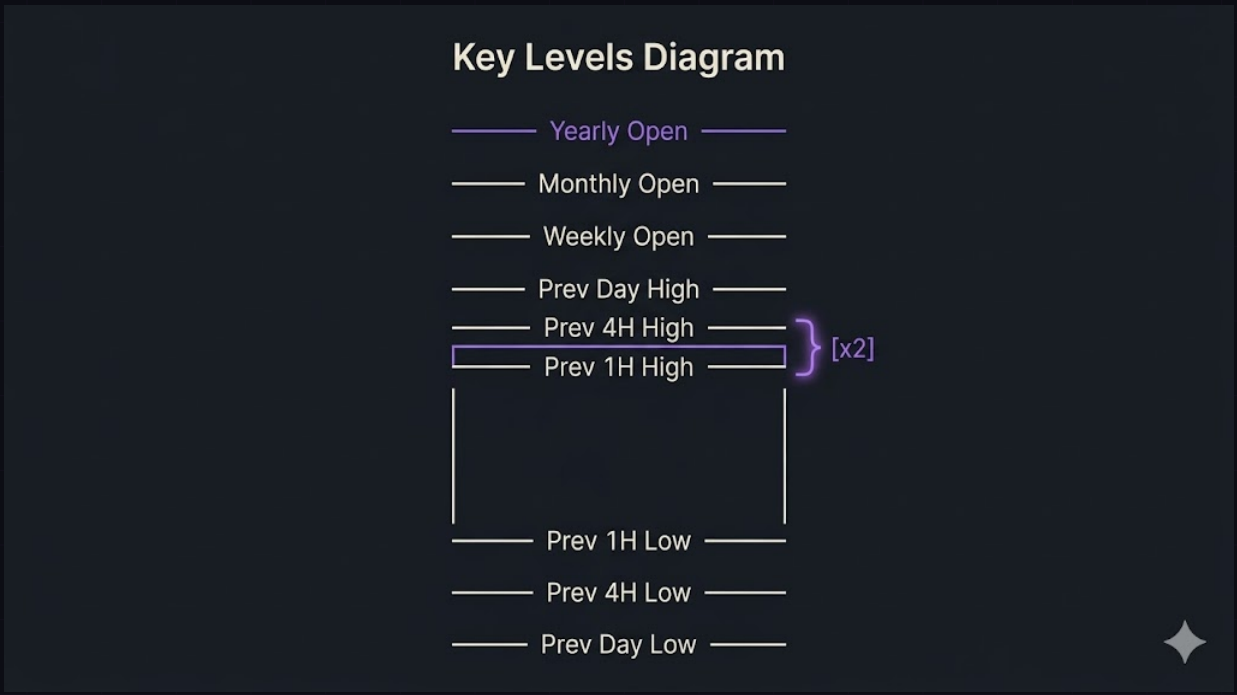

FIG 2.1 — Key Session Levels Hierarchy

// CHAPTER 03

Volume Profile Explained

Volume profile shows where the most trading activity occurred during a session — not just how much volume traded in total. It reveals the market's accepted value range and the magnetic price zones that attract and repel price.

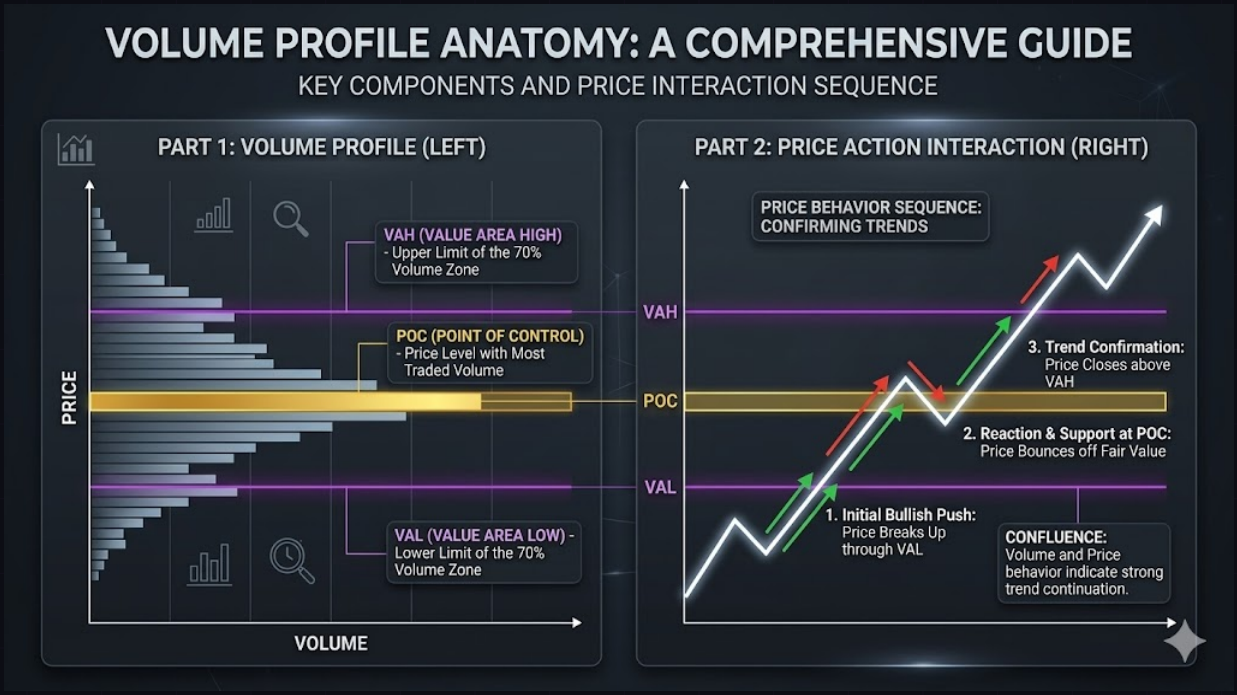

FIG 3.1 — Volume Profile Anatomy: POC, VAH, and VAL

The Three Key Levels

POC — Point of Control	The single price level with the highest traded volume during the session. Price gravitates back to POC, especially in choppy or mean-reverting conditions. On the 80 Tick Alpha charts, the POC appears as a YELLOW horizontal line.
VAH — Value Area High	The upper boundary of the Value Area — the top of the price range where 70% of the session's volume traded. Price above VAH is considered "above value." Breakouts above VAH that hold can lead to continuation moves. Shown as a PURPLE line.

VAL — Value Area Low	The lower boundary of the Value Area. Price below VAL is "below value." Strong support zone when aligned with session levels. Failures at VAL often accelerate downside momentum. Shown as a PURPLE line.

How to Use Volume Profile in Trades

SCENARIO	MEANING	BIAS
Price above POC + VAH	Sustained above-value acceptance	Bullish — hold longs, look for VAH as suppo
Price at POC, ranging	Market in balance / discovery mode	Neutral — wait for breakout of value area
Price below POC + VAL	Below-value, bearish acceptance	Bearish — short against VAL as resistance
Price reclaims VAL from below	Failed breakdown attempt	Potential reversal — watch for conf. long
Price rejects VAH on approach	Resistance holding above value	Bearish — short with stop above VAH

Pro tip: When a session's POC aligns with a key session level (e.g., Previous Day Low + POC), the resulting confluence zone is exceptionally high-probability. This is the core setup.

// CHAPTER 04

Trade Setup Examples

Every trade in this methodology follows the same checklist: a key level, volume confirmation, and market sentiment alignment. Below are the two core setups — a long and a short — showing exactly how the system works in real conditions.

Setup A — Long at Confluence Support

Price has pulled back to a zone where the Prev Day Low, the VAL, and a session open all converge within 5 points — a [x3] confluence. The Mag 7 screener shows 60%+ bullish readings. We wait for the 80-tick range bar to form a bullish reversal candle.

COMPONENT	DETAIL
Zone	Prev Day Low + VAL + Weekly Open → 21,440–21,445 [x3]
Entry Trigger	Bullish reversal candle on 80-tick chart closing above zone
Stop Loss	Below the [x3] confluence zone → 21,428
Target 1	Session POC → 21,500 (+55 pts)
Target 2	Prev Day High → 21,580 (+135 pts)
R:R	1:4+ at T1 | 1:11+ at T2
Sentiment Check	Mag 7 showing bullish bias 60%+

FIG 4.1 — Long Setup: Price Bounces from Confluence Support [x3]

Setup B — Short at Confluence Resistance

Price has rallied into a zone where the Prev Day High and the VAH align — a [x2] confluence. The Mag 7 screener is showing bearish readings (NVDA, MSFT rolling over). We wait for a rejection candle on the 80-tick chart before entering.

COMPONENT	DETAIL
Zone	Prev Day High + VAH → 21,880–21,885 [x2]
Entry Trigger	Bearish rejection candle on 80-tick, close below zone
Stop Loss	Above the [x2] zone → 21,900
Target 1	Session POC → 21,810 (+70 pts)
Target 2	Prev Day Low / VAL → 21,720 (+160 pts)
R:R	1:4.5 at T1 | 1:10+ at T2
Sentiment Check	Mag 7 showing bearish bias 55%+

FIG 4.2 — Short Setup: Price Rejects Confluence Resistance [x2]

Key rule: If price reaches your zone but the Mag 7 sentiment is neutral or opposing, reduce size or skip the trade. Sentiment alignment is not optional — it's the filter.

// CHAPTER 05

Risk Management & Psychology

Technical edge means nothing without the discipline to execute it consistently. The majority of losses in trading don't come from bad analysis — they come from good analysis executed poorly. This section is the most important in the guide.

> *"Your job isn't to be right. Your job is to be disciplined. The market handles the rest."*

Risk Framework

RULE	PARAMETER
Max risk per trade	0.5% – 1.0% of total account
Max daily loss (hard stop)	2.0% — shut the platform, walk away
Max trades per session	1 – 3 setups only
Minimum R:R to take a trade	1:3 or better
Position sizing method	Fixed $ risk / (entry – stop in points × tick value)

Partial profit taking	Scale out 50% at T1, move stop to breakeven, let T2 run

The Psychology Stack

PATIENCE IS THE EDGE	The setup either comes to your level or it doesn't. Chasing price is not part of this system. If NQ blows through your zone without the trigger, there is no trade.
STOP LOSSES ARE NOT NEGOTIABLE	Every trade has a stop. Every single one. Moving a stop wider because "price needs room" is how accounts blow up. Define risk before entry, respect it after.
PROCESS OVER OUTCOME	A losing trade executed correctly is a WIN. A winning trade where you broke rules is a loss. Judge yourself on process, not P&L; — especially early on.
REVENGE TRADING IS A CAPITAL DRAIN	After a loss, you must wait for the next valid setup — not enter something to "get it back." One bad trade is recoverable. Revenge trading is not.
THE DAILY HARD STOP EXISTS FOR A REASON	When you hit your 2% daily loss limit, you are done. Period. The market will be there tomorrow. Your account might not be if you ignore this rule.

Join the 80 Tick Alpha Discord community for live pre-market level breakdowns, the complete Pine Script indicator suite, and daily accountability threads. Follow @80TickAlpha on X for the daily NQ analysis thread.

NOT FINANC